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Introduction

This procedure describes the way internal audits are planned, managed and carried out, according to the requirements of sub clause 8.8 of the PNS ISO/IEC 17025:2017 standard.

1. Responsibilities & Authorities

1. Laboratory Manager
2. Quality Assurance Manager
3. Technical Manager
4. Staff

2. Planning of Internal Audits

2.1. Planning of internal audits is carried out by the Quality Assurance Manager and approved by the Laboratory Manager through the document **Annual Program of Internal Audits (LF 18-02)**, and covers:

- All elements of the quality system
- All laboratory units of BFAR RFL XII
- The designated auditors
- The Date/Time of each audit

2.2. The auditors are proposed by the Quality Assurance Manager and Approved by the Laboratory Manager. The auditors must meet the following criteria:

1. Independence in the management hierarchy of the section to be audited.
2. Training and technical knowledge.(specific Training on Auditing ISO 17025)

In addition, BFAR RFL may use external experts as internal auditors upon the decision of the Laboratory Manager.

3. Conduction of Internal Audits

3.1. Every element of the quality system and every unit of BFAR RFL XII is assessed at least once a year according to program of internal audits.

Prepared by: MA. MAURICE A. BANQUILING Quality Assurance Manager	Reviewed and Approved by: EUGENE GAY B. JAMORA Laboratory Manager
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3.2. Audits are carried out by the use of a standard questionnaire (LF 18-03, Audit Questionnaire Form) for each procedure. The questionnaires are written by the Quality Assurance Manager and approved by the Laboratory Manager according to SOP-13, Document Control. Each questionnaire contains specific control points, which correspond to the paragraphs of the respective procedure.

Note: Every procedure is covered by one section of questionnaire. In this respect, the total number of audit section of questionnaires is equal to the total number of SOPs and Work Instructions. The identification of each part of the questionnaire form is made by its title, since all questionnaire have the same document code (i.e. LF 18-01), according to SOP-13, Document Control procedure.

3.3. The audits are carried out as follows:

1. Each QM and SOP procedure is assessed individually and horizontally to include all involved units.
2. WIs and Laboratory procedures are assessed individually within the respective laboratory.

Include audit criteria

4. Recording the Findings of Internal Audits

4.1. The findings of any audit are recorded in the questionnaire (LF 18-03) according to the instruction therein (non-conformities, comments, evidence, etc.), given that all findings of an internal audit constitute deviations from the specifications of the quality system.

4.2. At the end of the assessment of any procedure:

1. The auditor completes the Audit Questionnaire Form (LF 18-03).
2. Defines in cooperation with the auditee, the corrective & preventive actions in the end part of the Form (LF 18-01 Corrective of Internal Audit Form) of Internal Audits.

4.3. By the completion of the whole group of audits in a specific time of the year according to the Annual Program of Internal Audits (LF 18-02), the auditors:

1. Submit all questionnaires (LF 18-03) and the filed respective forms for corrective/preventive actions to the Quality Assurance Manager.

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2. Leave copies of the forms LF 18-01 pointed out agreed CA/PA to the department/laboratory.

4.4. The Quality Assurance Manager, writes the Internal Audit Report (LF 18-04), based on the documents of par.4.3, which summarizes the findings of the audits. The Internal Audit Report is submitted to the Laboratory Manager and to the Regional Director and is discussed during management meetings and reviews.

5. Follow up and Implementation of Corrective / Preventive Actions

5.1. The implementation of the assigned corrective / preventive actions is the responsibility of the respective head of each laboratory unit according to the findings as recorded in the Form CA/PA of Internal Audits in LF 18-01.

5.2. The control of the implementation is carried out by the Quality Assurance Manager:

1. During routine controls
2. During the assessment of the procedure of Internal Audits (i.e. present procedure).

In any case, a final control for the implementation of corrective/preventive actions takes place at the next internal audit of the respective procedure of the system.

5.3. Normally, the assessment of this procedure takes place at the end of the year and after the completion of all audits. The objective of this assessment is to check:

1. If all documents have been assessed according to the annual program.
2. If there is enough evidence for the findings of the auditors.
3. The status of the implementation of corrective / preventive actions

5. Documents and Forms

Include document on audit report and other forms related to internal audit

LF 18-01, Corrective/Preventive Actions of Internal Audit Form

LF 18-02, Annual Program of Internal Audits

LF 18-03, Audit Questionnaire Form

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LF 18-04, Internal Audit Report

7. Document History

Revision No.	Issue Date	Original Entry	Revised as	Recall Date

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